

Say–Mean–Matter chart: Lesson 12 Determining Word Means and Their Impact on meaning and tone.

Word	Say (what the text says)	Mean (what the word means)	Matter (why it's important)
perspective	The speaker/viewpoint in the text shifts to a different perspective .	This means a way of seeing something, an attitude or point of view.	This matters because understanding whose perspective we're seeing can help us analyze bias, motivation, or how the argument is constructed.
consequence	The author warns of consequences if people don't act.	Here, "consequence" means the result or effect of an action.	This matters because it shows the stakes — knowing what might happen can make the author's argument more urgent or persuasive.
significant	The text describes a significant change in how the city uses energy.	"Significant" means important, or large in effect or meaning.	This matters because the change isn't trivial — it's important to the author's main point about innovation or responsibility.
implement	The city plans to implement new sustainable technologies.	"Implement" means to put into action or carry out a plan.	This matters because it shows that the idea is not just hypothetical — they intend to make real changes, which strengthens the argument.
persuade	The author tries to persuade readers that we must change how we commute.	"Persuade" means to convince someone to believe or do something.	This matters because it reveals the author's purpose: they're not just informing us, they want us to <i>do</i> something, which helps us analyze rhetorical strategies.